

AI Deployment Use Cases, Reskilling Strategy, and Autonomous Frontiers



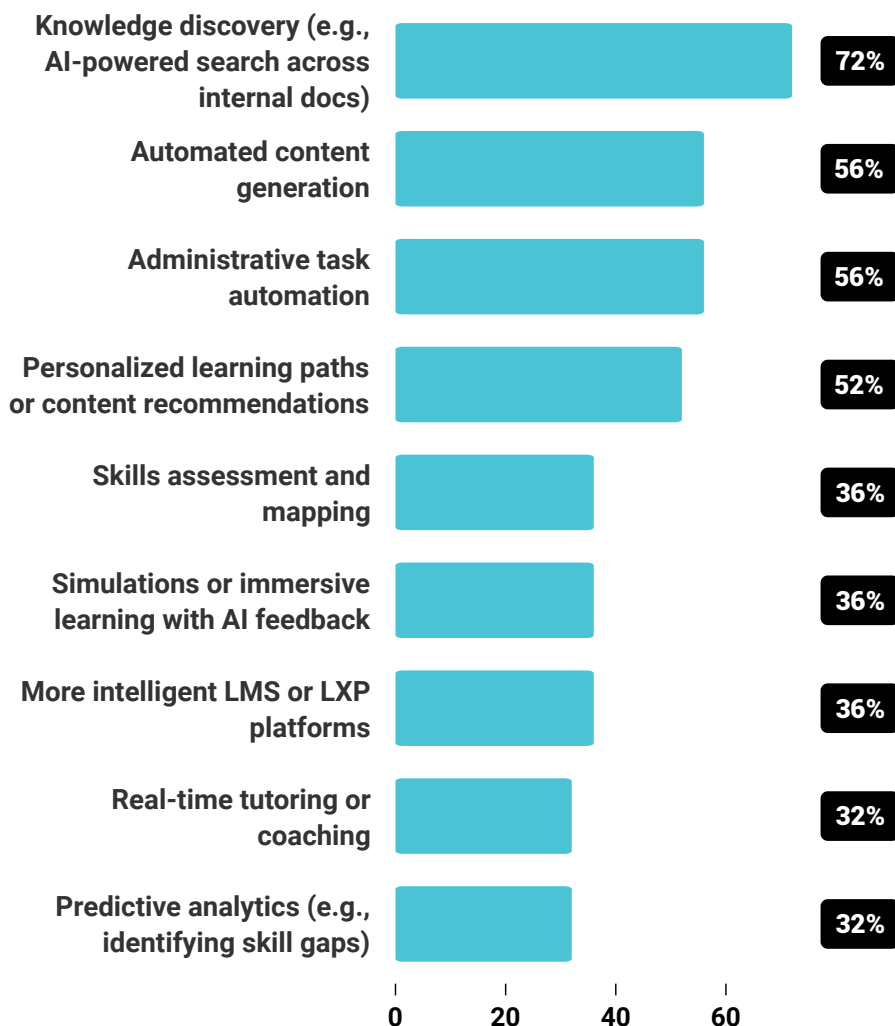
Finding: Nearly three-quarters of organizations use AI primarily for knowledge discovery and search across internal documents

The role of AI in L&D is evolving rapidly. In 2025, the most common AI application was content generation, with organizations primarily using AI to create learning materials. In 2026, among organizations using AI for learning, knowledge discovery and search emerged as the leading use case (72%), suggesting that organizations are increasingly using AI to help employees access, navigate, and retrieve information from existing knowledge repositories.

This shift reflects a broader move toward supporting learning at the point of need. Organizations are increasingly using AI to help employees find answers, solve problems, and access information within their daily work. Administrative automation (56%), automated content generation (56%) and personalized learning recommendations (52%) also rank among the most common use cases, reinforcing the view that current AI investments are largely focused on improving efficiency and accessibility.

Global framework by [Synthesia AI](#) confirms that while AI adoption is sky-high, it remains structurally “shallow.” Most L&D teams have normalized AI for fast administrative execution (drafting quizzes, generating voiceovers), but they lack the strategic infrastructure to drive outcome-focused practices.

How does your organization currently use AI for learning? (select all that apply)



The qualitative data strongly mirrors the quantitative shift toward using AI for localized, in-the-flow information retrieval rather than just raw content generation. David Creelman expects AI to fundamentally reshape delivery. He says, *"It will dominate learning, in particular offering excellent just-in-time, in the flow of work, training."*

Matthew Casey-Sudvary sees AI's primary immediate value in *"Creating individualized recommendations/paths."* JD Dillon points out that AI will democratize tool creation, moving power away from centralized L&D departments.

"AI will shift learning and enablement closer to the work, empowering people like managers, SMEs, and employees to build/deploy support tools without requiring centralized support every time." - JD Dillon

Willis pushes this integrated view of AI even further, arguing that its greatest potential lies in total ecosystem connection rather than standalone features. She explains,

"Massive AI needs to be the tool that brings all of the business data together with the skills, development and integrates with other apps NOT added in." - Becky Willis



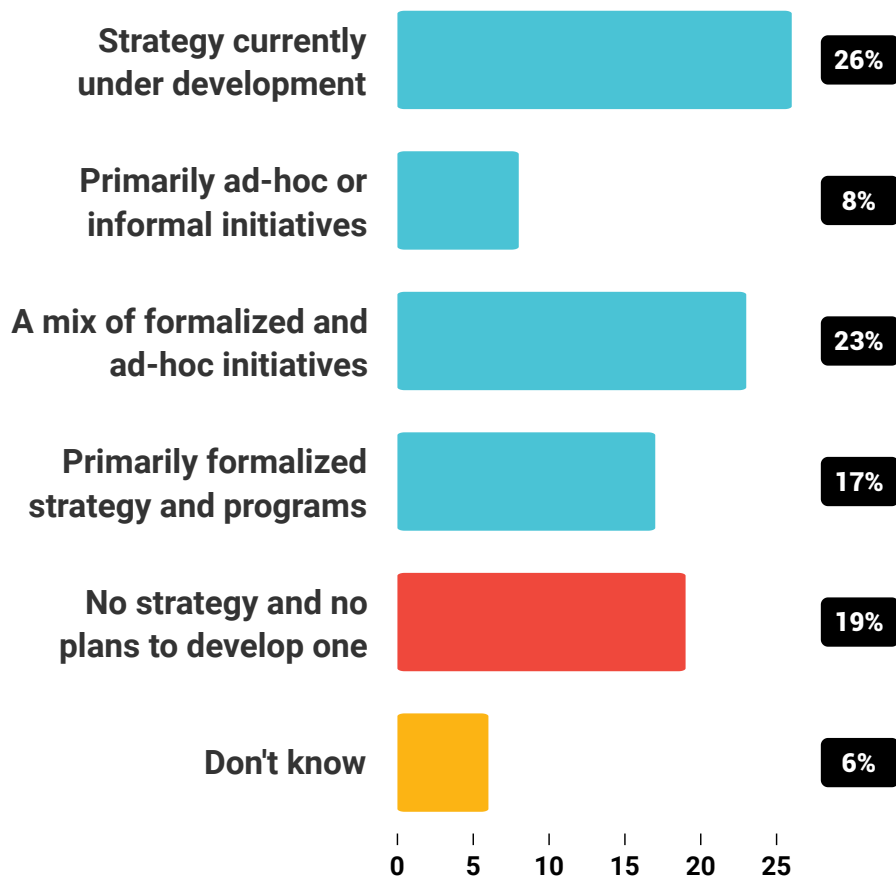
Finding: A quarter of organizations report that their AI reskilling strategy is currently under development

As AI adoption accelerates, [workforce readiness](#) is emerging as a key barrier to transformation. The challenge is no longer recognizing the need for AI skills, but building the processes and learning infrastructure required to develop them at scale.

When asked about their organization's current approach to reskilling employees in response to AI, a quarter (26%) report that their AI reskilling strategy is currently under development, making it the most common response. Many organizations are likely still in the early stages because AI technologies, required skills, and business use cases continue to evolve rapidly, making it difficult to identify future skill needs and develop comprehensive, organization-wide reskilling programs.

An additional 23% report having a mix of formal and informal initiatives in place, while 17% have established a formal strategy and 19% have no strategy at all. Together, these findings suggest that most organizations have begun taking steps to prepare their workforces for the impact of AI, even if many efforts remain in the early stages of maturity.

Which of the following best describes your organization's current approach to reskilling employees in response to AI?



Longitudinal data reveals a significant shift in organizational attitudes toward AI workforce readiness. In 2024, 44% of organizations reported having no AI reskilling strategy and no plans to develop one. That figure declined to 38% in 2025 and just 19% in 2026. This sharp decline suggests that AI workforce preparation is increasingly viewed as a business necessity rather than an optional initiative.

A [study](#) of more than 500 global enterprise leaders highlights a significant gap between AI ambitions and workforce readiness. While 82% provide some form of AI training or resources, only 35% have a mature, organization-wide AI upskilling program.

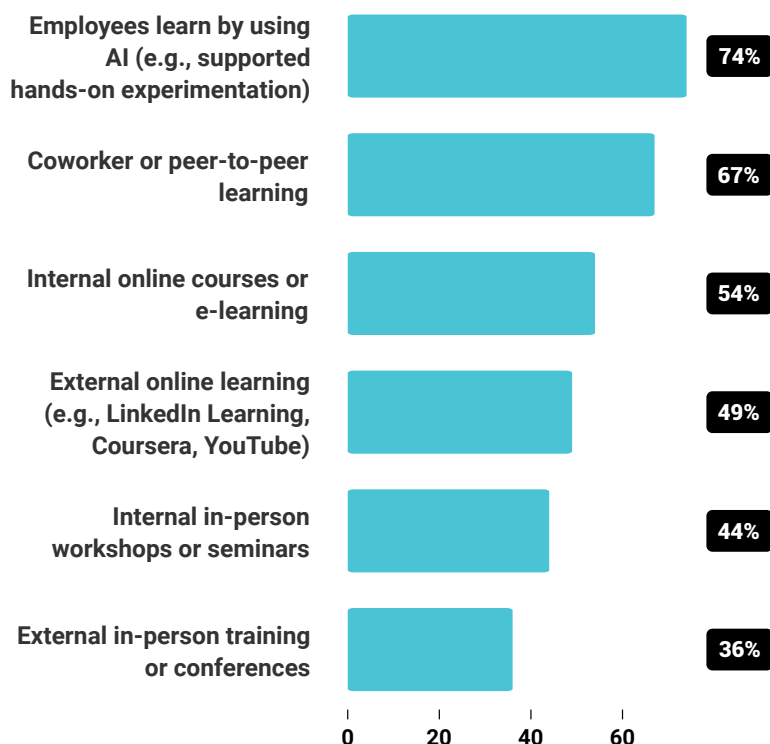


Finding: Three-quarters of organizations deliver AI training through hands-on experimentation supported by the organization

Organizations that have some strategy for reskilling employees in response to AI, overwhelmingly favor experiential learning approaches when developing AI skills (74%) and peer-to-peer learning (67%). This reflects the practical nature of AI adoption, where proficiency is often built through experimentation, iteration, and real-world application rather than traditional classroom instruction.

Despite the emphasis on hands-on learning, more traditional approaches remain common. Internal online courses are used by 54% of organizations, and 49% rely on external learning platforms and content libraries.

What methods does your organization use to deliver reskilling initiatives related to AI? (select all that apply)





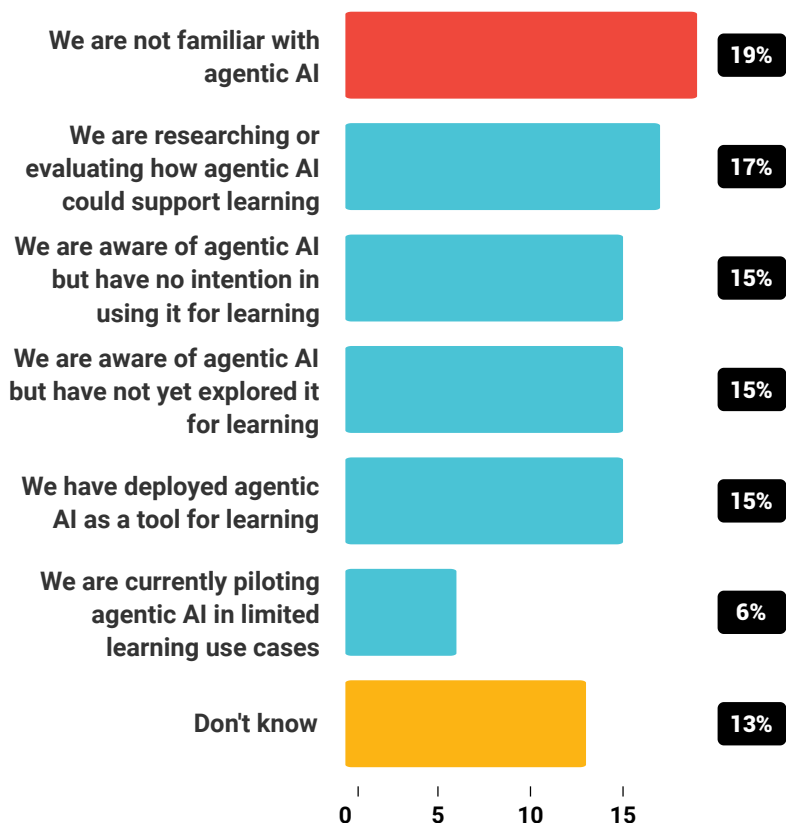
Finding: Under a fifth of organizations are actively researching or evaluating how agentic AI can support L&D

Agentic AI remains an emerging concept for most organizations. Unlike traditional AI tools, agentic AI can autonomously plan, execute, and coordinate tasks. [Experts](#) suggest it could transform L&D by providing personalized guidance, identifying skill gaps, and embedding learning directly into daily work.

While 17% of respondents are actively researching or evaluating potential applications, 19% report being unfamiliar with agentic AI, 13% are unsure of its implications, and another 15% are aware of the technology but have no plans to explore it.

[Industry analysts](#) suggest that while organizations are actively exploring agentic AI, adoption remains cautious due to legal, privacy, and operational risks associated with autonomous systems. Although adoption is still relatively low, a subset of organizations has begun moving beyond exploration and into practical experimentation through pilot programs (6%).

Which of the following best describes how agentic AI is used to support employee learning?



Note: AI agents are tools that can carry out multi-step tasks on behalf of users.

HRRI Strategic Recommendations

Based on our research, please consider the following suggestions:

1. Build a structured AI workforce readiness strategy

Many organizations recognize the importance of AI but are still developing formal approaches to workforce preparation. A clear strategy can help ensure employees develop the skills needed to work effectively alongside AI. Consider:

- defining AI capabilities required across different roles
- creating role-based learning pathways
- establishing workforce readiness goals
- aligning AI skill development with business priorities

2. Focus AI on workforce capability, not just productivity

Many organizations are successfully using AI to improve efficiency and access to information. The next opportunity is using AI to strengthen skills, support career growth, and improve workforce readiness. Consider:

- identifying workforce challenges AI can help address
- supporting personalized learning and development
- exploring AI-enabled coaching and learning support
- evaluating workforce outcomes alongside productivity gains

3. Create opportunities for employees to learn by doing

AI capabilities are often developed through experimentation and real-world application. Employees need opportunities to explore tools, test ideas, and share successful practices. Consider:

- providing safe environments to test AI tools
- encouraging peer learning and knowledge sharing
- incorporating practical exercises into AI training
- showcasing successful AI applications across the organization

4. Strengthen governance as AI adoption expands

As AI becomes more embedded in workplace processes, clear policies and oversight become increasingly important. Governance helps organizations manage risk while supporting innovation. Consider:

- establishing guidelines for responsible AI use
- clarifying data privacy and security expectations
- defining accountability for AI oversight
- reviewing emerging risks and opportunities regularly

5. Prepare for emerging AI capabilities

While many organizations are still exploring agentic AI, workforce leaders can begin building the knowledge and skills needed to evaluate future applications. Consider:

- monitoring emerging AI technologies and use cases
- building AI literacy among HR and learning teams
- evaluating where autonomous systems may add value
- assessing potential workforce implications of advanced AI

